Saman Shafiq, PhD

Assistant Professor | Researcher | Analytics Engineer
Elgin, Illinois · linkedin.com/in/samanshafiq · sshafi7@uic.edu

SUMMARY

Data and policy researcher with a PhD in Public Policy, Management, and Data Analytics and nine years at the University of Illinois Chicago. Teaches graduate and undergraduate data analytics while publishing peer-reviewed research on nonprofit networks and collaborative governance. Works hands-on in SQL, R, dbt, and Snowflake, with experience turning survey, administrative, and network data into reports and dashboards for government decision makers.

EXPERIENCE

UIC Department of Public Policy, Management, and Analytics, Chicago, IL

Assistant Professor Aug 2024 - Present

- Design and teach graduate and undergraduate courses in data analysis, civic technology, and public policy.
- Build data-driven curricula around real-world applications, using data visualization, dashboards, and case studies.
- Conduct and publish peer-reviewed research on nonprofit roles, network formation, and collaborative governance.
- Courses: Public Policy and Analysis, Introduction to Civic Technology, Economics for Management and Policy, Principles of Data Analysis, Coding for Civic Data Applications.

Adjunct Professor Aug 2023 - Aug 2024

- Taught graduate and undergraduate courses in data analysis, civic technology, and public policy.
- Designed applied coursework built on case studies, data visualization, and dashboards.

Data Analyst, Network Governance Lab Aug 2019 - Aug 2023

- Co-led analysis of nonprofit participation in interlocal agreements using the Iowa 28E dataset, applying negative binomial regression, degree centrality analysis, and network mapping.
- Modeled network formation and stakeholder behavior with SIENA and ego network models.
- Designed and ran survey research, including sampling, outreach, and interviews.
- Co-led the Northern Illinois Benchmarking Collaborative, a benchmarking initiative on police and fire services for 12 municipalities.
- Worked with government stakeholders to define performance metrics, then gathered data through surveys, focus groups, and observational studies.
- Analyzed and visualized results in SQL and R, and delivered reports to inform municipal decisions.

Graduate Teaching Assistant Aug 2017 - May 2023

- Supported graduate courses in Data Analysis, Advanced Data Analysis, and Economics for Management and Policy, and undergraduate courses in Evaluating Public Policies and Programs and Civic Technology.

Institute for Policy and Civic Engagement at UIC

Research Specialist Oct 2023 - May 2024

- Served on the monitoring team for the Chicago Police Department Consent Decree, ensuring compliance with study protocols and data governance standards.
- Conducted quantitative and qualitative analysis in R and SQL with a focus on data privacy and disclosure control.
- Used sdcMicro to assess and reduce re-identification risk in sensitive respondent data.

Illinois Department of Transportation, Chicago, IL

Policy Analyst Sep 2016 - Aug 2017

- Supported development of the 2017 Long Range Transportation Plan and helped draft the final report, synthesizing research, stakeholder input, and transportation data into policy recommendations.
- Analyzed survey data on public sentiment, travel behavior, and infrastructure needs.
- Performed GIS spatial analysis to identify regional transportation trends, equity impacts, and investment opportunities.

Institute of Development and Economic Alternatives (IDEAS), Lahore

Research Assistant Jul 2015 - Jul 2016

- Designed sampling frameworks and survey instruments for the Punjab Economic Opportunities Program, a Government of Punjab poverty alleviation initiative, and helped train and supervise field coordinators.
- Designed data collection instruments for a study of learning outcomes and teacher effectiveness in India and Pakistan, and wrote a manual documenting instructional practices.
- Cleaned, structured, and modeled data in statistical software to evaluate learning outcomes.

Center for Economic Research in Pakistan (CERP), Lahore

Research Assistant Dec 2014 - May 2015

- Coordinated fieldwork with the survey firm for the Women's Mobility Project, a study of how mobility constraints affect labor force participation and education.
- Led a team of interns conducting phone follow-ups to verify data quality and completeness.
- Analyzed survey data on barriers to transportation access, contributing to policy recommendations.

EDUCATION

PhD, Public Policy, Management, and Data Analytics, University of Illinois Chicago 2018 - 2023

Dissertation on measuring publicness in networks and its links to network structure, governance, and performance.

Master of Public Administration, University of Illinois Chicago 2016 - 2018

Bachelor's Degree, Economics and Psychology, Lahore University of Management Sciences 2011 - 2015

Activities: Emergency Medical Services (EMS); SPADES, Director and Assistant Director; LUMS Political Society.

SKILLS

- **Tools and technologies:** SQL, R, Python, dbt, Snowflake, Tableau, GIS, sdcMicro, databases
- **Analytics and methods:** statistical analysis and inference, regression modeling, social network analysis (SIENA, ego network models), survey design, qualitative research, data visualization, dashboards, data processing and manipulation
- **Teaching and research:** higher education teaching, online teaching, scholarly research, case studies, presentations

PUBLICATIONS

Kurtz, S., **Shafiq, S.**, & Albrecht, K. (2026). Network embeddedness and monitoring mechanisms in government-nonprofit public service delivery agreements. *The American Review of Public Administration, 56*(3), 274-294. https://doi.org/10.1177/02750740251411848

Albrecht, K., & **Shafiq, S.** (2024). Collaboration with nonprofit organizations. In C. G. Reddick & T. Demir (Eds.), *Handbook of public service delivery* (pp. 118-135). Edward Elgar Publishing. https://doi.org/10.4337/9781035315314.00014

Shafiq, S., Albrecht, K., & LeRoux, K. (2023). Extending the interdependence theory to local public service provision: Evidence from Iowa. *Nonprofit Policy Forum, 14*(3), 255-278. https://doi.org/10.1515/npf-2022-0036

Shafiq, S., Kapousouz, E., Siciliano, M. D., & Gawel, J. M. (2022). Benchmarking local government services: Applying an issue-based approach. *State and Local Government Review, 54*(3), 267-279. https://doi.org/10.1177/0160323X221113367

CERTIFICATIONS

- The Complete dbt Bootcamp: Zero to Hero, Udemy, May 2025
- dbt Fundamentals, dbt Labs, November 2024
- Data Analyst in SQL, DataCamp, March 2024
- Medical First Responder (Paramedic), Rescue 1122 Punjab, January 2014